LESSON 20

Relative pronouns and relative clauses

Relative pronouns

SUBJECT	OBJECT	POSSESSIVE
who	who/whom	whose
which	which	whose
that	that	---

We use relative pronouns to introduce **relative clauses**.

My friend, **who** is a doctor, examined my mother.
This is the dress **which** I would like to return.
It is a company **that** treats employees well.

We use:

- *who* and *whom* for **people**
- *which* for **things**
- *that* for **people or things**

whose and whom

We use ***whose*** as the **possessive** form of *who*:

This is Penny, **<u>whose</u> mother was my Maths teacher**.

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We sometimes use ***whom*** as the **object** of a verb or preposition:

> This is Lisa, **whom you met at my birthday party 5 years ago**.
> (*whom* is the object of *met*)
>
> This is Teddy's brother, **with whom I went to the gym last year**.
> (*whom* is the object of *with*)

Nowadays we normally use *who*:

> This is Lisa, **who you met at my birthday party 5 years ago**.
> This is George's brother, **who I went to the gym with**.

when and where

We can use *when* with times and *where* with places to **make it clear which time or place** we are talking about:

> Italy won the World Cup in 2006. It was the year **when I graduated**.
> I remember my graduation party. It was the day **when Italy won the world cup**.
>
> Do you remember the place **where we first met**?
> Salzburg is the town **where Mozart was born**.

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